

SMART KOPARGAON HACKATHON 2026

JUDGES' GUIDELINES AND EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

1. Purpose

This document provides the evaluation framework and judging guidelines for the **Smart Kopargaon Hackathon 2026 Grand Finale**. The objective is to ensure a fair, transparent, consistent, and merit-based evaluation of all participating teams.

A total of **100 teams** will participate across **8 domains**. Judges are expected to evaluate teams based on the quality of their existing project, their ability to address the new challenges introduced during the hackathon, technical implementation, innovation, impact, and overall feasibility.

2. Evaluation Structure – 50:50 Weightage

The evaluation will follow a **50:50 evaluation model**.

Evaluation Component	Weightage
Existing Project – Project that qualified the team for the Grand Finale	50%
New Problem Statement / Challenge introduced during the hackathon	50%
Total	100%

2.1 Existing Project – 50%

The first 50% of the evaluation will assess the project/prototype that enabled the team to qualify for the Grand Finale.

Judges should consider:

- Innovation and uniqueness
- Technical implementation

- Prototype maturity
- Functionality
- Problem relevance
- Usability
- Scalability
- Potential impact
- Existing development and progress
- Quality of demonstration

2.2 New Problem Statement / Challenge – 50%

During the Grand Finale, new problem statements/challenges may be introduced. Teams will be expected to further develop, adapt, integrate, or extend their existing projects to address the given challenge.

Judges should consider:

- Understanding of the new problem
- Innovation of the approach
- Technical feasibility
- Quality of implementation
- Integration with the existing project
- Working functionality
- Effectiveness of the proposed solution
- Scalability
- Potential real-world impact
- Final demonstration

Final Score

Final Score = (Existing Project Score × 50%) + (New Challenge Score × 50%)

3. Evaluation Criteria

The following criteria shall be used for evaluating both components of the 50:50 evaluation framework.

Sr. No.	Evaluation Criterion	Weightage
1	Innovation & Uniqueness	15%
2	Technical Soundness & Feasibility	15%
3	Prototype Development & Functionality	20%
4	Problem Relevance & Effectiveness	15%
5	Integration & Scalability	10%
6	Usability & User Experience	10%
7	Impact & Market Readiness	10%
8	Presentation & Final Demonstration	5%
	Total	100%

4. Detailed Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	What Judges Should Evaluate
Innovation & Uniqueness	Originality, creativity, novelty and differentiation from existing solutions
Technical Soundness & Feasibility	Architecture, technology selection, reliability, technical implementation and feasibility
Prototype Development & Functionality	Working prototype, completeness, core features and quality of implementation
Problem Relevance & Effectiveness	Understanding of the problem, relevance to users and effectiveness of the proposed solution
Integration & Scalability	Integration of components, scalability, deployment potential and ability to handle growth
Usability & User Experience	Ease of use, accessibility, interface quality and practical adoption
Impact & Market Readiness	Social, economic or environmental impact, sustainability and real-world deployment potential
Presentation & Final Demonstration	Clarity, quality of demonstration, communication and response to questions

5. Domains

The Grand Finale will cover the following **8 domains**:

Sr. No.	Domain
1	Open Innovation
2	Agriculture
3	Transportation
4	Education
5	Food Safety & Security
6	Industry & MSME Innovation
7	Health
8	Waste Management

Note: The final domain-wise team distribution should be verified before the final judge allocation, as the currently provided domain counts add up to more than 100 teams.

6. Overall Prize Selection

The **1st, 2nd and 3rd prizes will be overall prizes**, irrespective of the domain in which the team participates.

Selection Pool	Number of Teams	Purpose
Pool 1	Top 8 teams	Final competition for 1st Prize
Pool 2	Next 8 teams	Final competition for 2nd Prize
Pool 3	Next 8 teams	Final competition for 3rd Prize

The highest-performing team in each respective pool will receive the corresponding overall prize.

Overall Prize Eligibility

- Teams from **any of the 8 domains** can qualify for the overall prizes.

- Domain does not restrict eligibility for 1st, 2nd or 3rd prize.
- The final ranking will be based on the consolidated evaluation score.
- Judges should not consider institutional affiliation, team size, or location while awarding scores.

7. Domain-Specific Awards

In addition to the overall prizes, **one Domain Award will be given in each of the 8 domains.**

Domain	Domain Award
Open Innovation	1 Winner
Agriculture	1 Winner
Transportation	1 Winner
Education	1 Winner
Food Safety & Security	1 Winner
Industry & MSME Innovation	1 Winner
Health	1 Winner
Waste Management	1 Winner

Domain Award Rule

A team that receives the **1st, 2nd or 3rd Overall Prize will not be eligible for a Domain-Specific Award.**

If the highest-ranked team in a particular domain receives an overall prize, the **next highest-ranked eligible team from that domain** will be selected as the Domain Winner.

8. Judges' Guidelines

Guideline	Instructions
Objectivity	Evaluate solely on the defined criteria and demonstrated performance
Fairness	Apply the same evaluation standards to all teams

Prototype Verification	Ask teams to demonstrate important claimed functionalities
Technical Assessment	Examine the technical approach, implementation and feasibility
Problem Understanding	Assess how well the team understands and addresses the problem
Questioning	Ask relevant questions to verify technical and practical claims
Impact Assessment	Consider measurable and realistic real-world impact
Documentation	Record scores and observations clearly
Confidentiality	Do not disclose individual scores or rankings during evaluation
Conflict of Interest	Judges should disclose any potential conflict before evaluating a team
Final Decision	Rankings will be based on the consolidated evaluation results

9. Evaluation Process

Stage	Activity
1	Team reporting and verification
2	Initial evaluation briefing for judges
3	Evaluation of existing project
4	Introduction of new problem statement/challenge
5	Teams work on and integrate the challenge
6	Evaluation of new challenge implementation
7	Consolidation of 50% + 50% scores
8	Identification of top-performing teams
9	Formation of Pool 1, Pool 2 and Pool 3
10	Final jury evaluation for overall prizes
11	Selection of 8 Domain Winners
12	Final verification of results
13	Announcement of results and prize distribution

10. Final Award Structure

Award Category	Number of Winners
1st Overall Prize	1
2nd Overall Prize	1
3rd Overall Prize	1
Domain-Specific Awards	8
Total Major Award Winners	11

11. Important Note for Judges

The evaluation must reflect **both the team's existing achievement and its ability to innovate further during the hackathon**. The 50:50 model ensures that teams are rewarded not only for the project that brought them to the Grand Finale but also for their ability to respond to new challenges, improve their solution, and demonstrate real-world implementation capability.

All evaluation decisions should be based on merit, evidence, demonstrated functionality, technical quality, innovation, and potential impact.